MIL-P-3558E
5 November 1982
SUPERSEDING
MIL-P-3558D
30 December 1975

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PLATES, IDENTIFICATION: LOCOMOTIVES AND RAILWAY CARS

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers identification plates for railway rolling stock.

1.2 Classification. Identification plates shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Locomotives.
Type II - Freight and specialty cars.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-S-781	- Strapping, Steel, and Seals.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640	- Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Mobility Equipment Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDME-DS, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 2240

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MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation-Packaging, Methods of.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-889 - Dissimilar Metals.
MIL-STD-1188 - Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.2 Other publications. The following document(s) form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issues of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

AMERICAN SOCIETY OF TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

A27 - Mild-To-Medium-Strength Carbon-Steel Castings for General Applications.
A47 - Malleable Iron Castings.
A48 - Gray Iron Castings.
A743 - Corrosion-Resistant Iron-Chromium, Iron-Chromium-Nickel and Nickel-Base Alloy Castings for General Applications.
B26 - Aluminum-Alloy Sand Castings.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The plates shall be as shown in figure 1 and 2 as applicable, and as specified herein.

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3.2 Material. The identification plates shall be of the following material, as specified (see 6.2):

Material	Conforming to
Malleable iron	ASTM A47, Grade 32510
Corrosion-resistant steel	ASTM A743, Grade CA-15
Aluminum alloy	ASTM B26, UNS A24430, Temper F
Open hearth steel	ASTM A27, Grade 65-35
Gray iron	ASTM A48, Class 20B

3.2.1 Dissimilar Metals. Dissimilar metals, if used, shall be in compliance with MIL-STD-889.

3.3 Contour of plate. When specified (see 6.2), the plate shall be contoured and the contour shall be as specified.

3.4 Dimensions. Dimensions for the type and style plate specified shall be as shown on the applicable figure.

3.5 Lettering. All letters and numerals shall be as shown on the applicable figure. Letters shall be Gothic capitals and numerals shall be Arabic. Supplemental information shall be as specified (see 6.2). Supplemental information shall include the nomenclature, Government numbers, and any additional information required to correctly identify the piece of equipment. All information specified which is common to all plates shall be in raised letters cast integrally with the plate. All letters, numerals, and other symbols which will normally vary on each plate shall be stamped on the embossment area indicated by the solid lined spaces on the applicable figure. The largest figures the embossment will accommodate, such as a 1/2-inch figure for a 5/8-inch embossment or a 1/4-inch figure for a 5/16-inch embossment, shall be used. The depth of the stamped letters shall insure legibility should they become covered with paint.

3.6 Attaching devices. When specified (see 6.2), tamperproof fasteners of semipermanent type and size shall be furnished for the purpose of securing the plate to the applicable surface.

3.7 Type I, locomotives. Type I identification plates shall be used to identify locomotives and shall conform to figure 1.

3.8 Type II, freight and specialty cars. Type II identification plates conforming to figure 2 shall be used to identify flat cars, box cars, tank cars, other types of freight cars and any specialty cars (such as guard cars or cabooses).

3.9 Workmanship. All plates shall have smooth edges and shall be free of cracks, burrs, sharp edges, and projections. Markings shall be neat and legible, and spacing and arrangement of lettering shall be uniform.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspections. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Component and material inspection. The contractor is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications and standards, as applicable.

4.2 Classification of inspections. Inspections shall be classified as follows:

a. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.3).
b. Inspection of packaging (see 4.5).

4.3 Quality conformance inspection.

4.3.1 Sampling. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level S-3.

4.3.2 Examination. Samples selected in accordance with 4.3.1 shall be examined as specified in 4.4.1. AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.4 Inspection procedure.

4.4.1 Examination. The plates shall be examined as specified herein for the following major defects:

101. Materials not as specified.
102. Contour of plate not as specified.
103. Dimensions not as specified.
104. Markings missing, incorrect, illegible, or incomplete.
105. Holes not drilled or punched to size specified.
106. Workmanship not as specified.

4.5 Inspection of packaging.

4.5.1 Quality conformance inspection of pack.

4.5.1.1 Unit of product. For the purpose of inspection, a completed pack prepared for shipment shall be considered a unit of product.

4.5.1.2 Sampling. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

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4.5.1.3 Examination. Samples selected in accordance with 4.5.1.2 shall be examined for the following defects. AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

107. Materials, methods, or containers not as specified. Each incorrect material, method, or container shall constitute one defect.
108. Plates of unlike description consolidated together for level A.
109. Consolidated boxes exceed the weight limitations of the box specification for level A.
110. Plates of unlike description packed together for level A or B.
111. Gross weight or size exceeds the limitations of the box specifications for level A or B.
112. Strapping not as specified for level A.
113. Marking missing, illegible, incorrect, or incomplete.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each plate shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, Method IC-1 or IC-3.

5.1.1.1 Consolidation. The preserved plates of like description shall be consolidated together in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5c or W6c, style optional, in quantities not to exceed the weight limitation of the box specification.

5.1.2 Commercial. Each plate shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Plates of like description, preserved and consolidated as specified in 5.1, shall be packed together in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-601, Overseas Type, Grade B, style optional in quantities not to exceed the weight limitation of the box specification. Box closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification, except that strapping shall conform to QQ-S-781, Class 1, Type I or IV, size as applicable; and, unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), strapping shall be finish B. When specified (see 6.2), strapping shall be finish A.

5.2.2 Level B. Plates of like description, preserved and consolidated as specified in 5.1, shall be packed together in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c, style optional or PPP-B-640, Class 2, style optional. The gross weight or size shall not exceed the limitations of the applicable box specifications.

5.2.3 Commercial. Plates, preserved and consolidated as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

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5.3 Marking. Levels A and B shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Commercial packaging shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Identification plates are intended for attachment to railway locomotives, cranes, motor cars, various types of railway rolling stock, and work equipment.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type of plate required (see 1.2).
c. Material required (see 3.2)
d. When a contoured plate is required and the contour required (see 3.3).
e. Supplemental information required on plates (see 3.5).
f. When fasteners are required, and type and size required (see 3.6).
g. Degree of packaging required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
h. When strapping shall be other than as specified (see 5.2.1).

6.3 Packaging applicability. When this specification is referenced for use in an end item specification, Section 5 shall not be applicable.

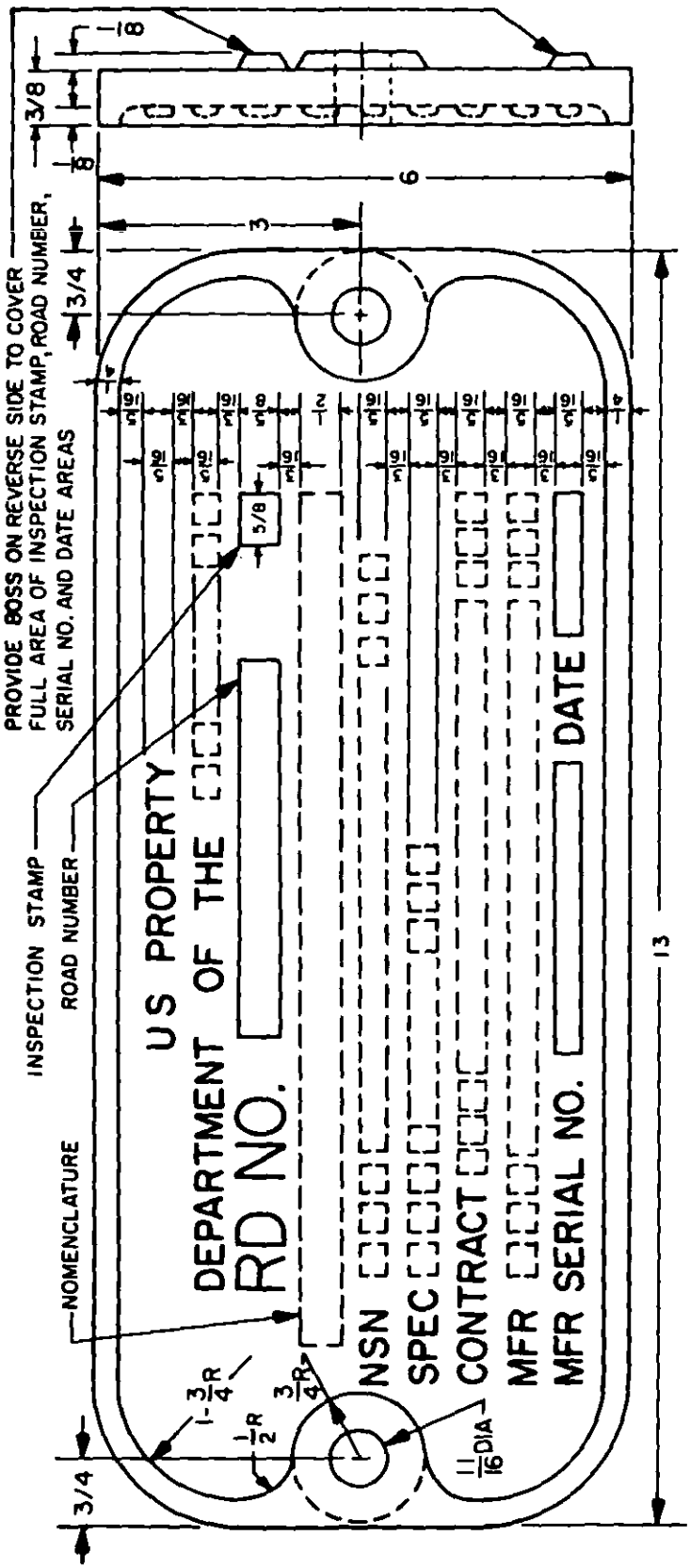
6.4 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the specification (see 3.2).

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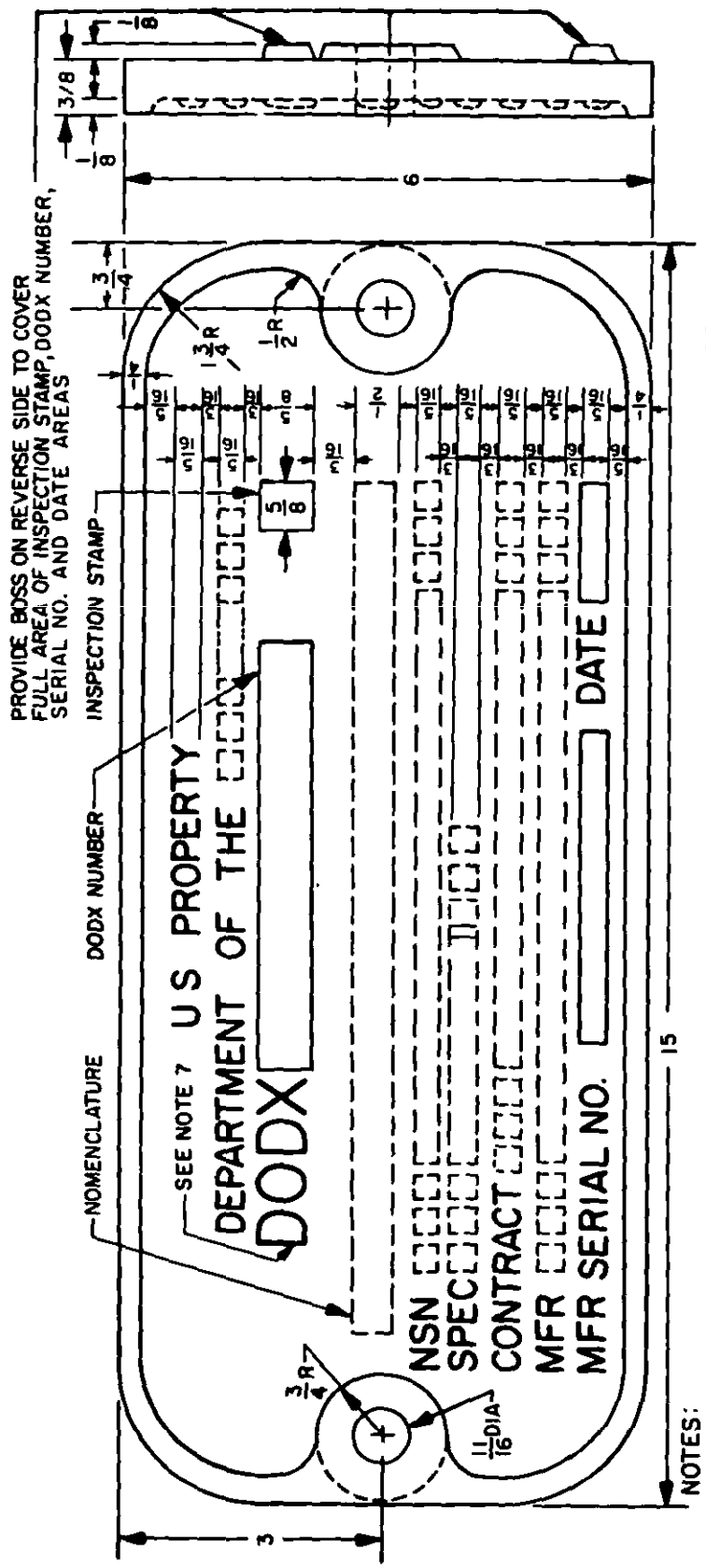


NOTES:
1. ALL CAST LETTERS AND SURFACES FOR STAMPING SHALL BE RAISED A MINIMUM OF 1/32-INCH.
2. ⊏⊐ INDICATES WHERE LETTERS AND NUMERALS SHALL BE CAST.
3. ▭ INDICATES EMBOSSMENT WHERE LETTERS AND NUMERALS SHALL BE STAMPED.
4. LENGTH OF PLATE MAY BE INCREASED TO 15-INCHES IF REQUIRED.
5. DATE SHALL INCLUDE MONTH AND YEAR.
6. ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.
7. INSPECTION STAMP EMBOSSMENT TO BE STAMPED BY GOVERNMENT INSPECTOR UPON ACCEPTANCE OF LOCOMOTIVES.

FIGURE 1. Identification plate for locomotives.

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NOTES:
1. ALL CAST LETTERS AND SURFACES FOR STAMPING SHALL BE RAISED A MINIMUM OF 1/32-INCH.
2. [ ] INDICATES WHERE LETTERS AND NUMBERS SHALL BE CAST.
3. [ ] INDICATES EMBOSSMENT WHERE LETTERS AND NUMBERS SHALL BE STAMPED.
4. DATE SHALL INCLUDE MONTH AND YEAR.
5. ALL DIMENSIONS SHOWN IN INCHES.
6. INSPECTION STAMP EMBOSSMENT TO BE STAMPED BY GOVERNMENT INSPECTOR UPON ACCEPTANCE OF FREIGHT CARS.
7. USE REPORTING MARKS AS DESIGNATED IN SPEC (E.G., USAX, DAPX, USNX, etc.)

FIGURE 2. Identification plate for freight and specialty cars.

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MIL-P-3558E Plates, Identification: Locomotives and Railway Cars

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B. RECOMMENDED WORDING CHANGE

C. REASON FOR RECOMMENDED CHANGE(S)

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